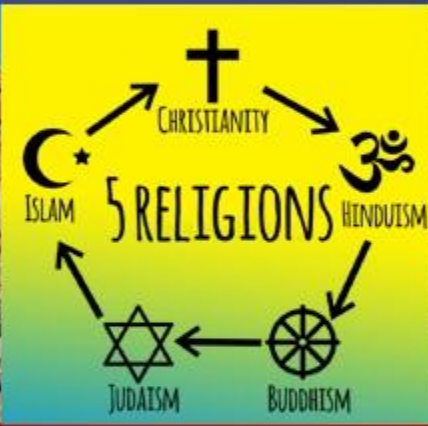


# ART & CULTURE



## INDIAN PAINTINGS

**MODULE - 9**

**FOLK PAINTINGS**



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

5

## PAITKAR PAINTING



*Jharkhand, Odisha, West Bengal regions*



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

5

## PAITKAR PAINTING

- 1 Practiced by the tribal people of Jharkahand, Paitkar paintings or scroll paintings are considered one of the ancient schools of painting in the country.



- 2 This old form of painting has cultural association with Goddess Manasa (Goddess of Serpents), one of the most popular goddesses in Bengali household.

- 3 These paintings are linked to the social and religious customs including giving alms and holding Yajnas. The common theme of Paitkar paintings is “What happens to human life post death”.

- 4 Although an ancient art, it is on the verge of extinction given the rate of its decline.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

6

## KALAMKARI PAINTINGS



*Andhra Pradesh region*



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

6

## KALAMKARI PAINTINGS



- 1 The name comes from **Kalam**, i.e a **pen**, which is used to paint these exquisite paintings.
- 2 The pen used is made of **sharp pointed bamboo**, used to regulate the flow of colours. The base is **cotton fabric** while the **colours used are vegetable dyes**.
- 3 The main centres for this art are **Srikalahasti and Machilipatnam** in the State of Andhra Pradesh.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

6

## KALAMKARI PAINTINGS



**4** The artists in the Srikalahasti region create beautiful wall hangings. The images are drawn free hand and the inspiration comes from Hindu Mythology.

**5** Textiles with handwork are also produced here.

**6** The artists in the Machilipatnam area use different designs including the cartwheel, lotus flower, animals and interlacing patterns of flowers and leaves among other things.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

7

## WARLI PAINTINGS



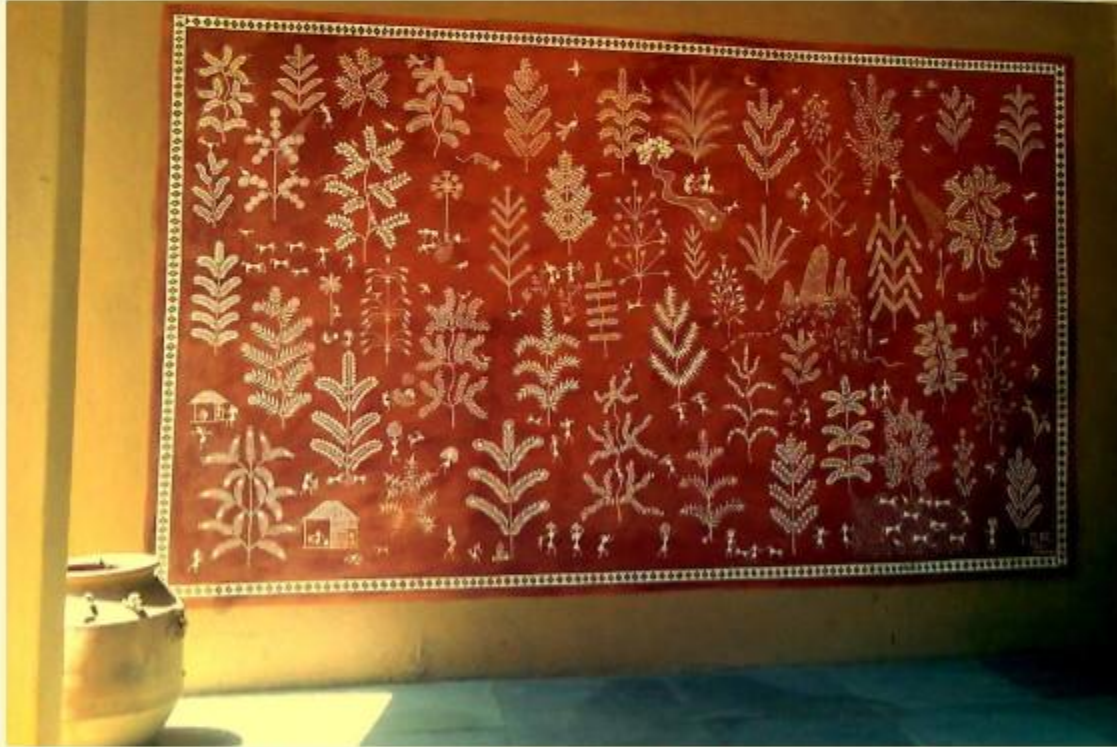
*Maharashtra region*



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

7

## WARLI PAINTINGS



*Warli paintings, at Sanskriti Kendra Museum, Anandagram, New Delhi.*

- 1** The name of the painting comes from the people who have been carrying the painting tradition that goes back to 2500-3000 BC.
- 2** They are called the Warlis, indigenous people that occupy mainly the **Gujarat-Maharashtra border**.
- 3** These paintings have close resemblance to the **mural paintings of Bhimbetka in Madhya Pradesh** that date back to the pre-historic period.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

7

## WARLI PAINTINGS



4

These ritualistic paintings usually represents scenes portraying fishing, hunting, farming, dances animals, trees and festivals.

5

Among the Goddesses, **Palaghata** (Goddesses of fertility) drawn and among the **male god**, those **spirits that have taken human form** are represented.

6

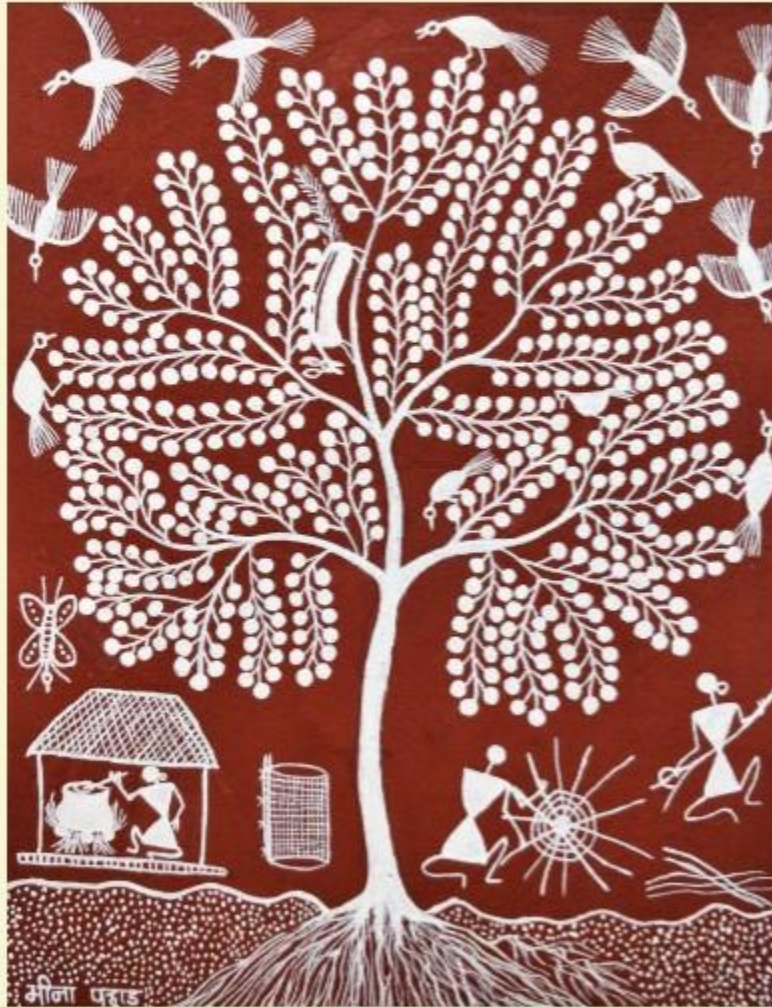
Traditionally, the paintings are done on the walls using **very basic graphic vocabulary**, including a triangle, a circle and a square.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

7

## WARLI PAINTINGS



7 These shapes are inspired from nature i.e circle from sun or moon, triangle from conical shaped trees or mountains and square from sacred enclosure or piece of land.

8 To represent a human or animal, two triangles are joined at the tip, with circles acting like their head.

9 The base is made of a mixture of mud, branches and cow dung that gives it a red ochre colour.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

7

## WARLI PAINTINGS



**10** For painting **only white pigment** is used, which is made of mixture of **gum and rice powder**.

**11** The wall paintings are usually done for auspicious occasions like **harvests and wedding**.

**12** With time, the popularity of Warli painting has resulted in these being painted on a cloth on a base of red or black background using white poster colour.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

8

## THANGKA PAINTINGS



*Sikkim region*



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

8

## THANGKA PAINTINGS



*Commercialisation of Thangka painting*

- 1 Belonging to the Indian State of Sikkim, Thangka were originally used as a medium of reverence that evoked the highest ideals of Buddhist.
- 2 Traditionally made by Buddhist monks and particular ethnic group, the skill of these paintings has been passed from one generation to the other.
- 3 It has now spread a greater number of people and to an extent been commercialized.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

8

## THANGKA PAINTINGS



4 The earnings from the paintings are used not only to keep the art form alive and sustain the artist but **also to help the monasteries.**

5 Thangkas are painted on a **base of cotton canvas (White Background)** with **paints made from natural vegetable dyes** or mineral dyes.

6 The colours used in the paintings have their own significance. For example, red stands of intensity of passion, be it love or hatred, golden is for life or birth, white is for serenity, green represents consciousness and yellow shows compassion.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

8

## THANGKA PAINTINGS



7

Once the painting is done, it is often framed in colourful silk brocade.

8

Thangkas can be divided into three types according to their depiction and meaning.

- The first kind shows the life of Buddha from his birth to his enlightenment.
- The second kind is more abstract; it represents Buddhist beliefs of life and death including “Wheel of Life”.
- The third kind represents paintings that are used for offerings to the deities or meditation.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

9

## MANJUSHA PAINTINGS



*Bhagalpur (Bihar) region*



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

9

## MANJUSHA PAINTINGS



*Snakes were mostly present in these paintings*

- 1 This art form belongs to Bhagalpur region of Bihar. It is also known as **Angika Art**, where “Ang” refers to one of the Mahajanapada.
- 2 Since snake motifs are always present, it is also called **snake painting**. These paintings are executed on boxes of jute and paper.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

10

## PHAD PAINTINGS



*Rajasthan Region*



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

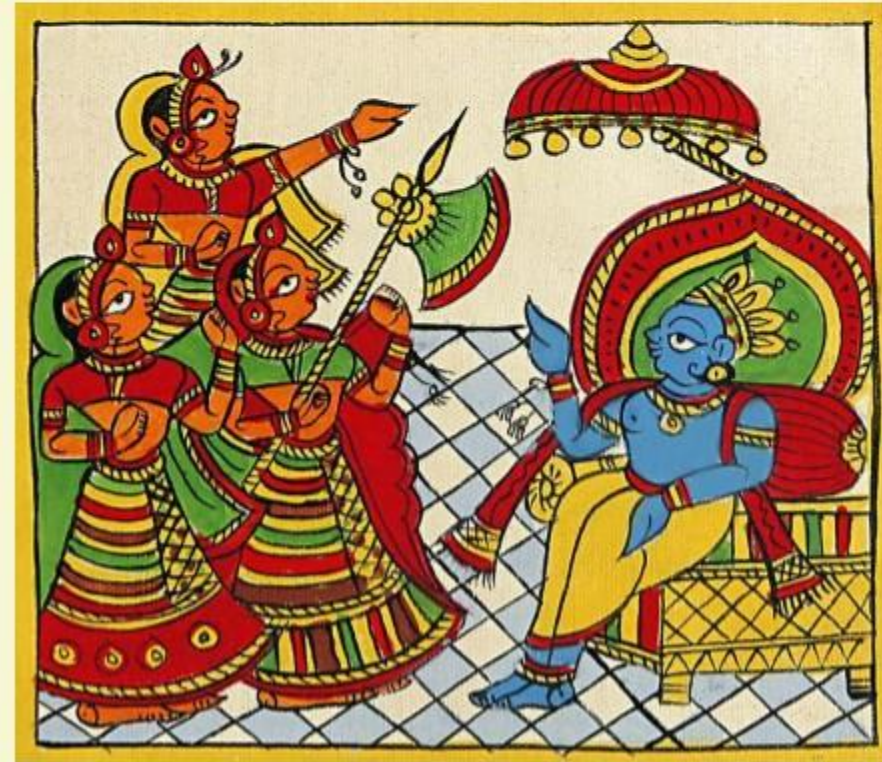
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## PHAD PAINTINGS

- 1 This folk art popular in Rajasthan is done on long scrolls of fabric/cloth at the end of which bamboo shafts are tied for rolling the scrolls.



- 2 The Bhopas who are priest singers, carry the Phads along with them which serves as temples of their folk deities.





# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

10

## PHAD PAINTINGS



*Phad paintings- the “travelling temples” of Rajasthan*

**3** Traditional examples of this art are Devnarayan Ki Phad and Pabuji Ki Phad. This style was revolutionized by Shree Lal Joshi and Pradip Mukherjee about forty years ago.

**4** Mukherjee's paintings are based on the stories of Ramcharitmanas, Gita Govinda, Kumārasambhava, Bhagavad Gita and Hanuman Chalisa.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

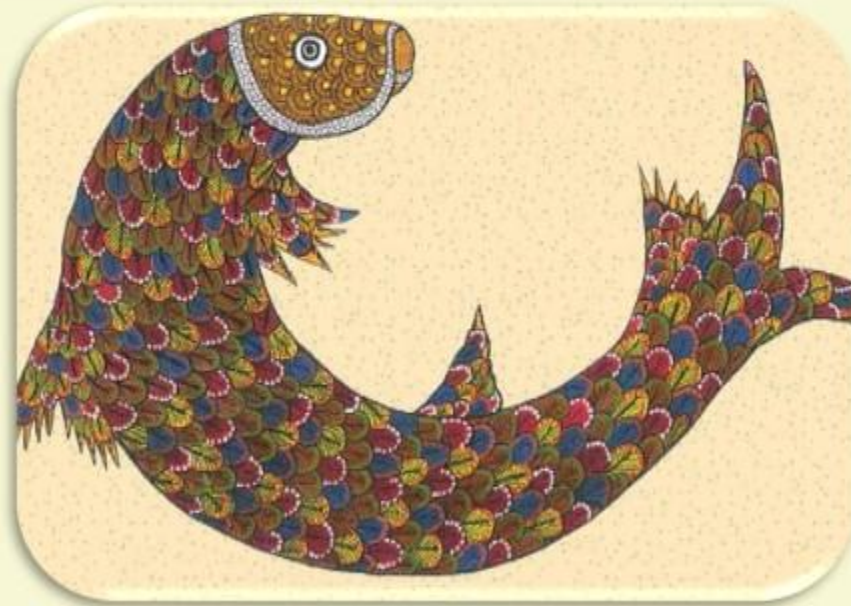
11

## TRIBAL PAINTINGS

A

### GOND PAINTINGS

1. Popular amongst **Gonds of Madhya Pradesh**, it is done on the walls of houses.
2. Later it has been done on canvas and paper also.
3. Contains images from folk stories, flora and fauna, etc.





# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

11

TRIBAL PAINTINGS

B

SANTHAL PAINTINGS



1. Santhal paintings are popular among the Santhal tribes of Jharkhand and West Bengal.
2. The themes are taken from natural surroundings and objects of daily life.
3. The images are simplistic and colours are bright and natural pigments are used.
4. Popular in the state of Jharkhand, it is one of the oldest tribal paintings.



# FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

## CONCLUSION

**1** Hence, we can see that India has a long tradition of art and paintings, which depict the essential things about our culture.

**2** There are various schools, some even overlap, and the artists who are involved in the making of these paintings are skilled beings.

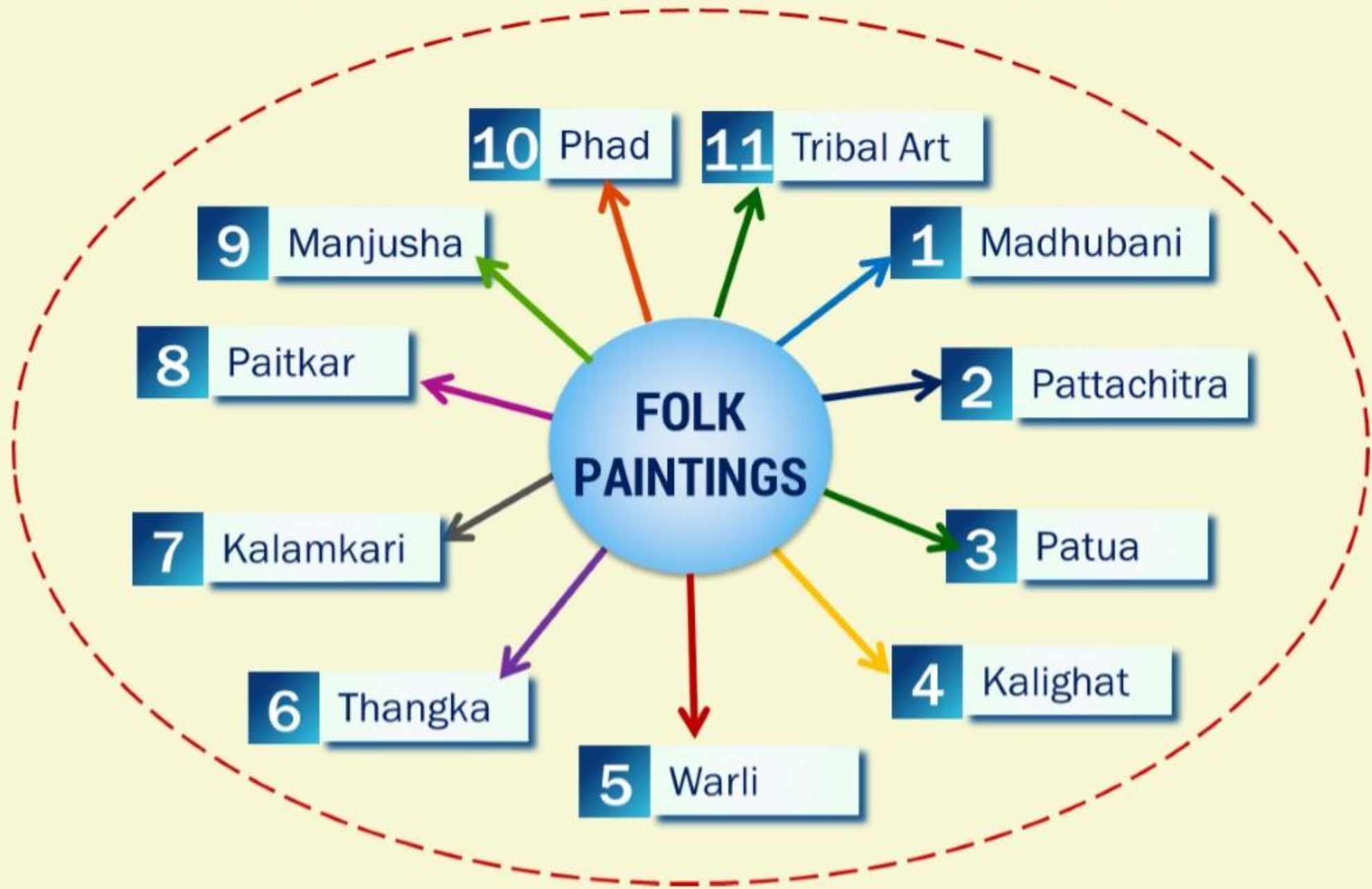
**3** Currently, some of the arts have a larger scope of survival as they have market and very few middle class Indians want to invest in good quality art.

**4** It is being polarized and has become a commodity in the hands of intellectuals and academicians or rich people.

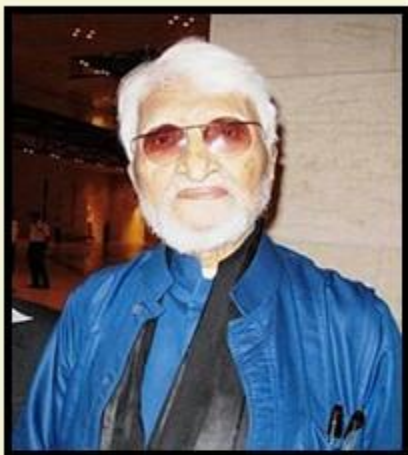
**5** The Government and various centres for the arts need to step up and make arts and paintings a matter of cultural heritage that should be disseminated amongst common people.



# COMPREHENSIVE LIST OF FOLK PAINTINGS







## IMPORTANT PERSONALITIES IN THE ART OF PAINTING

**RAJA RAVI VERMA**

**ABANINDRANATH TAGORE**

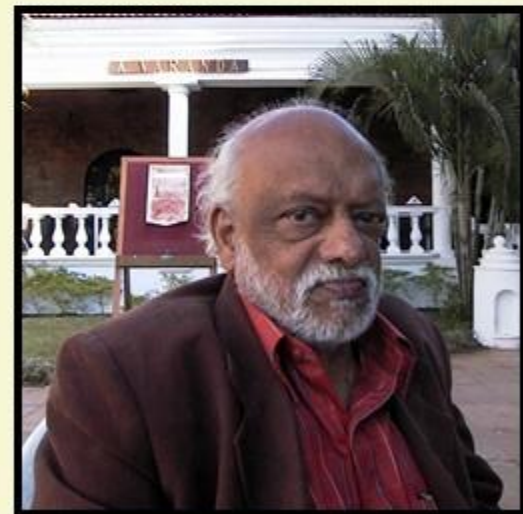
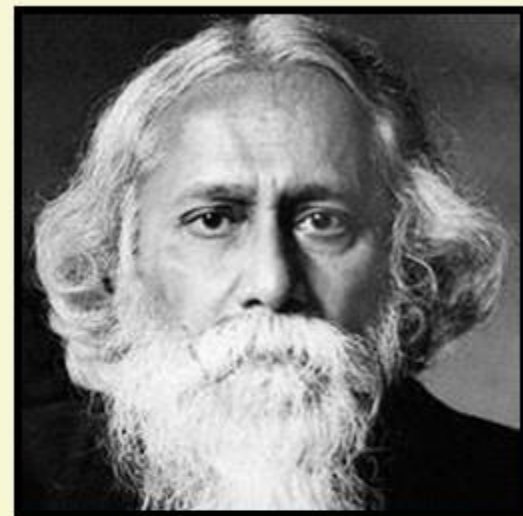
**RABINDRANATH TAGORE**

**MAQBOOL FIDA HUSSAIN**

**FRANCIS NEWTON SOUZA**

**SYED HAIDAR RAZA**

**JAMINI ROY**



*(All of the above painters have been dealt with in previous modules)*



# SOME PREVIOUS YEARS' MAINS QUESTIONS RELATED TO PAINTINGS

**2015**

- 1** Mesolithic rock cut architecture of India not only reflects the cultural life of the times but also a fine aesthetic sense comparable to modern painting. Critically evaluate this comment.

**2011**

- 2** While bringing out their salient features, distinguish between either 'Madhubani' Art and 'Manjusha' Art or 'Rajasthani' schools of painting and the 'Pahari' school of Painting.

**1993**

- 3** Write about the chief features of the Bundi school of painting.

**1990**

- 4** Write about the chief features of:
- a) Kishangarh style of painting
  - b) Neo art movement of Rabindra Nath Tagore
  - c) Kangra school of painting

**1985**

- 6** What are the basic differences between Mughal style of painting and Rajput style of painting?



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